

Dell Opts for Open Source to Deliver Efficient Systems Management to Enterprises

The Dell Power Edge Server's Out-of-Band management solution has been developed using various open source technologies to deliver cost-effective systems management for enterprise IT environments.



The engineering team at Dell EMC

When it comes to systems management in enterprises, several time consuming tasks are involved. Earlier, embedded solutions backed by some proprietary technologies seemed efficient and effective as customers were only looking at meeting the requirements through a particular technology. But the cost and flexibility of those solutions have today become the key factors driving customer decisions on what technology to opt for. The open standards, open architecture and open source technology based solutions come with improved time-to-market as well as enhanced affordability and scalability. And they come without the burden of vendor lock-in and the resultant huge costs.

Much before the market was fully ready for open source solutions, Dell opted for open standards and open architecture for its brand, PowerEdge. This is designed with 'open, affordable, reliable and scalable' architecture, and is aimed at

helping enterprise customers manage their servers through Out-of-Band (OOB) management. Known as iDRAC, the in-house technology for PowerEdge servers offers efficient and effective server management without requiring any operating system.

The engineering team at Dell EMC has designed the integrated Dell Remote Access Controller (iDRAC) with the LifeCycle Controller (LC) as an intelligent subsystem within servers to provide agentless OOB monitoring, management, configuration and updates. The company also provides IT administrators with its Chassis Management Controller (CMC) to deliver real-time monitoring of consolidated multiple blade servers and shared components in a Dell chassis.

Each of the Dell PowerEdge servers is shipped with the iDRAC, which leverages open standards and open source technologies. This helps the company offer faster development, reduced time-to-market and improved scalability over any proprietary and closed source development.